

Zandaley "Zan" Mignon Bothma

Instructional Designer · AI-Enhanced Learning · Adult E-Learning

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PROFILE

Early-career instructional designer focused on AI-enhanced learning, completing a Postgraduate Diploma in Instructional Design, with 8 years of teaching experience across Vietnam, China (remote) and South Africa. Throughout my diploma, I have both designed with generative AI and studied how to design for it. I configure Claude to play specific roles, such as a Socratic opponent that questions rather than answers, ground AI work in sources with Notebook Gemini, and document where LLMs help, mislead or steer. That work led to *CoTrace*, my own concept for an AI-enabled learning platform that makes human-AI collaboration at tertiary level visible and assessable.

I design for adult learners using andragogy, constructive alignment, UDL and multimedia learning principles, and my journalism background gives me a strong feel for story and plain language. I learn quickly and enjoy mastering new technologies on my own initiative. I'm looking to bring this mix of evidence-based design and hands-on AI experimentation to a team building smarter, more engaging e-learning.

KEY STRENGTHS

Generative AI in learning design
Prompting and configuring LLMs (Claude, Notebook Gemini) for defined learning roles; AI-assisted drafting of learning outcomes, assessment criteria, materials and code.

LLM capabilities and limitations
First-hand experience of unsupported claims, Western-default outputs and anchoring bias in LLM output, and designing around them with source grounding and line-by-line verification.

AI-enabled learning experiences
Designing AI interaction modes (Socratic, supportive, reflective) and scaffolded AI use; AI Assessment Scale, Generativism, care ethics in GenAI design.

Adult learning design
Andragogy, constructive alignment, Bloom's Digital Taxonomy, UDL, Mayer's multimedia principles, authentic assessment.

Human-centred design and prototyping
Double Diamond, IDEO methods, empathy maps, personas, storyboards, wireframes, pilot study design.

Storytelling and content
Narrative and plain-language writing from journalism training; narrative design methods such as Storytelling into the Future.

Project delivery
Running several diploma projects to fixed deadlines alongside part-time teaching; clear documentation of process and decisions.

AI-ENHANCED LEARNING DESIGN PROJECTS

Postgraduate Diploma in Instructional Design, Emeris / Vega, 2026 to present

- **CoTrace, AI-enabled learning platform (original concept):** Designed a platform concept that makes students' collaboration with AI visible and assessable. Specified distinct AI behaviours for each phase (a Socratic opponent while exploring, a background helper while drafting, and a supportive mode that asks guiding questions instead of rewriting), real-time detection of learning moments with adaptive reflection prompts, and planning to move towards a pilot simulated in a D2L Brightspace sandbox before any development.
- **Speculative design portfolio:** Ran a full Double Diamond process as a live experiment in human-AI co-creation, with Claude configured as a Socratic opponent and research grounded in Notebook Gemini. Kept an AI decision log and reflective journal, and identified how an early AI-generated outline anchored later thinking. Produced two speculative futures for AI in tertiary education.
- **Research proposal:** Proposed a study on design characteristics for a mechanism that surfaces cognitive friction in student-AI collaboration. Used Notebook Gemini to verify an AI-drafted literature table line by line, correcting claims the sources did not support.
- **Adult literacy curriculum (conceptual):** Used Claude to draft Bloom's-aligned learning outcomes and assessment criteria, then revised them to remove Western academic assumptions and reflect andragogy, Ubuntu and translanguaging for a hypothetical group of rural Zambian women.
- **Facilitator orientation programme (online):** Planned an online programme to help adult facilitators adopt a new AI learning platform, with learner personas, aligned outcomes, UDL principles and a storyboard and wireframe.

- **Workplace onboarding job aid:** Worked with a new employee at a natural stone wholesaler to capture her role in a job aid. The process showed the company that it needed a formal SOP for the role, which it then created due to my input.
- **Reflective journal website:** Designed and built an LMS-style multimodal journal on GitHub Pages (zandaleyid.github.io/journal), teaching myself to code it with AI assistance.

TEACHING AND LEARNING EXPERIENCE

Online English Teacher
2025 – present

Nice Tutor / Nice Kid, China (remote via ClassIn)

- Deliver live one-on-one online lessons to learners aged 5 to 16, working remotely from South Africa across time zones.

Secondary English Teacher
2023 – 2025

Ly Thai To Secondary School, Language Link Vietnam (Schools Link), Hanoi

- Produced a full set of weekly learning materials for Grade 6 English and English Literature, including slides, worksheets and interactive games built with multimedia and AI tools.
- **Awarded Teacher of the Year, Semester 1, 2024–2025**; above-standard ratings in all formal observations and performance reviews.

Secondary English Teacher
2022 – 2023

Marie Curie Secondary School, Language Link Vietnam (Schools Link), Hanoi

- Adapted National Geographic Impact 1 and 2 for Grades 6 and 7, creating original interactive materials and differentiating for mixed-ability classes.

Kindergarten and Primary ESL Teacher
2019 – 2022

Various public schools, Language Link Vietnam (Schools Elite and Schools Link), Hanoi

- Taught kindergarten and Grades 1 to 5 across multiple schools; above-standard ratings for the 2021–2022 final observation and overall performance.

Online ESL Teacher
2020

Landi English, online

- Taught learners aged 3 to 16 using structured lesson frameworks; tracked weekly progress and reported to parents.

Academic Literacy Facilitator
2018

Unit for Language Development, University of the Free State, South Africa

- Designed and delivered weekly academic literacy and business English lessons for first-year economics students.

Academic Writing Consultant
2017 – 2018

Centre for Teaching and Learning, University of the Free State, South Africa

- Gave students targeted feedback to develop the structure, clarity and referencing of their academic writing.

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

Postgraduate Diploma in Instructional Design
2026 – present

Emeris / Vega (The Independent Institute of Education), South Africa

- Modules: Instructional Design and Innovation · Approaches to Teaching and Learning in Africa · Multimodal Content for Online Learning · Instructional Design Research
- 80% or above in every formative and summative assessment to date.

Bachelor of Journalism (BJourn)
2012 – 2015

Rhodes University, Grahamstown, South Africa

- Specialisations: Photojournalism (2014), Digital Media (2015).

TEFL/TESOL Certificate (150 hours)
2017

Global Language Training, online

TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGY

AI tools	Claude, Notebook Gemini, Grammarly; prompting, role configuration, source grounding and verification, AI-assisted coding
Learning platforms	D2L Brightspace (sandbox), TalentLMS, ClassIn, Zoom
Design and prototyping	Canva, Whimsical (wireframes), storyboarding
Web and publishing	GitHub Pages
Productivity	Microsoft Office, Google Workspace

REFERENCES

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